

REMEMBER, REMEMBER

Our journey to rediscovering Linux starts off with an obscure diary entry

Setting: On an unknown day and date, sometime in October 2005, sometime in the evening in a college hostel...

Digit Reader (d): So you brought this piece of hardware all the way from home but didn't bring along an anti-virus?

Friend (F): No, I thought it wasn't needed, and the anti-virus that came bundled with the PC was ancient. I don't know man, I can't even locate my Windows install disk.

d: Well, have you tried Linux?

F: No, what's that? New version of Windows?

d: No, I found it in one of Digit's recent DVDs. And it's definitely not Windows. Everything about Linux is so different from Windows. I was so intrigued about it that I've already installed this Operating System, but I've yet to test this thing. And it has some weird name: Some SuSE or something similar. I had read about something related to Linux in Digit itself; so you know, I gave it a try.

F: Hmm, sounds interesting, but why'd you suddenly mention it when I told you about my virus problem? Does Linux not get infected by viruses?

d: Viruses apparently are mostly coded for Windows and since this is an entirely different OS, I don't think it has viruses. I have to look into it. Besides, my Windows had been giving me trouble too. There's nothing much on it anyway, just music so I didn't really care.

Two days later, when I actually got time, I went back to my PC and tried to start Windows. I popped in my Windows XP installation disk and ran the recovery process. Not surprisingly and to quite some relief, it worked. But my Linux installation was nowhere to be found. Plus, it seemed that my Windows partition had shrunk way more than it should have. As if this wasn't enough, I couldn't even find a way to look at the Linux files. There was simply no drive in 'My Computer' where I could see my Linux files. It was quite strange. Oh well time to shoot off a mail to Digit to ask for troubleshooting.